



Child Safeguarding Risk Assessment

Written Assessment of Risk of Cara Junior School

In accordance with section 11 of the Children First Act 2015 and with the requirement of Chapter 8 of the *Child Protection Procedures for Primary and Post-Primary Schools 2017*, the following is the Written Risk Assessment of [name of school].

1. List of school activities	2. The school has identified the following risk of harm in respect of its activities –	3. The school has the following procedures in place to address the risks of harm identified in this assessment -
Training of school personnel in Child Protection matters	Harm not recognised or reported promptly	Child Safeguarding Statement & DES procedures must be read by all staff DLP& DDLP to attend PDST face to face training All Staff to view Túsla training module & any other online training offered by PDST must be completed BOM records all records of staff and board training
One to one teaching	Harm by school personnel	Open doors Table between teacher and pupil Glass in window Intimate care policy

Toilet areas Use of toilet/changing/shower areas in schools	Inappropriate behaviour by staff	No students on placement allowed carry out intimate care unless trained by permanent staff
Curricular Provision in respect of SPHE, RSE, Stay safe.	Non-teaching of same	School implements SPHE, RSE, Stay Safe in full
Daily arrival and dispersal of pupils	Harm from older pupils, unknown adults dropping children off	Arrival and dispersal supervised by Teachers and SNA staff
Sports Coaches	Harm to pupils	Policy & Procedures in place: Safe guarding statement Health and Safety Policy Code of Conduct for Staff
Students participating in work experience	Harm by student on placement	Child Safeguarding Statement. Health & Safety Policy Garda vetting
Recreation breaks for pupils	Harm from other pupils/staff	Restrictive practice Policy Health & Safety Policy Code Of Behaviour Positive behaviour support plans

Classroom teaching	Harm by school personnel Harm from other students	Health & Safety Policy Code of conduct Restrictive practice policy Code of behaviour Classroom strategies i.e small class group, seating positions, high level of supervision
Outdoor teaching activities	Harm by school personnel Harm from other pupils	High pupil/staff ratio Code of conduct Code of behaviour Health and safety policy
Sporting Activities	Harm by non-school personnel	Health and safety policy Code of conduct
School outings	Harm by school and non- school personnel	High level of supervision Outings policy- risk assessment to be carried out, ensure grounds are secure , risk assess students who are known to abscond Child protection training carried out by all staff
Use of off-site facilities for school activities	Non -verbal students unable to tell if something has happened. Harm from general public and school personnel	Outings policy Health and safety policy Child protection training/procedures in place High level of supervision at all times. Risk assessment carried out prior to activity

School transport arrangements including use of bus escorts	Parents not being at home to receive students. Harm from transport personnel Harm from other students	Garda vetting procedures. Interview process for Bus escorts. Child protection training up to date. Dynamis training Child protection procedures for reporting to school if parents not at home in place. Incident report forms. Appropriate seating at all times. Transport policy
Management of challenging behaviour amongst pupils, including appropriate use of restraint where required	Harm by school personnel Harm from another student	Restrictive practice policy in place MAPA training provided Positive behaviour plans in place Health and safety policy Code of conduct High level of supervision in place Strategies identified to manage challenging behaviour incidents.
Administration of Medicine Administration of First Aid	Harm by school personnel Harm from adults	Administration of medication policy Locked storage for medication at all times First Aid training Child safeguarding policy Administration of medication record sheet where appropriate
Prevention and dealing with bullying amongst pupils	Harm from another student	Anti-bullying policy Code of behaviour

Training of school personnel in child protection matters	Harm by school personnel Not providing training Not keeping records of persons trained.	Child protection training carried out by all staff Records kept of all training certs, dates etc. Risk assessment collaboration with all school personnel.
Use of external personnel to supplement curriculum	Harm by non -school personnel Lack of understanding of ASD specific needs of students.	Careful consideration as to the suitability of external personnel. Child protection procedures High level of supervision Garda vetting required
Recruitment of school personnel including - • Teachers • SNA's • Caretaker/Secretary/Cleaners • Sports coaches • External Tutors/Guest Speakers • Volunteers/Parents in school activities • Visitors/contractors present in school during school hours • Visitors/contractors present during after school activities	Harm not recognised or properly or promptly reported Recruitment procedures not followed General freedom within the school during school hours.	Child Safeguarding Statement & DES procedures made available to all staff Staff to view Tusla training module & any other online training offered by PDST Vetting Procedures Policy of Parents / Volunteers Policy on Visiting Contractors No non-school personnel allowed on site without prior appointment.
Use of school premises by other organisation during school day	Harm by non- school personnel	Child safeguarding statement available.

Use of Information and Communication Technology by pupils in school Application of sanctions under the school's Code of Behaviour including detention of pupils, confiscation of phones etc.	Harm by non -school personnel Non -compliance with school policy.	Policy on visits to school by external personnel Child safeguarding statement available. Parents Association are the only organisation allowed within the building during the school day. Policy on visits to school by external personnel Code of behaviour Code of conduct Child safeguarding statement.
Students participating in work experience in the school	Harm by non -school personnel Lack of knowledge regarding ASD specific needs of students. Lack of experience in I.D setting	Garda vetting Confidentially policy No short- term work experience permitted Child safeguarding statement
Student teachers undertaking training placement in school	Harm by non- school personnel Lack of experience with ASD and I.D Lack of experience with challenging behaviour.	Garda vetting required Policy in place. No short- term work experience placements allowed
Use of video/photography/phones or other media to record school events	Harm by non -school personnel Harm by school personnel.	Permission forms signed for each student Record of permission forms kept on file in classrooms and office. Confidentially policy ICT and Acceptable internet use policy Mobile phone policy

General use of school environment	Non awareness of dangers in the environment i.e .leaving out resources which may eaten, found by other pupils, leaving door open.	Code of conduct for staff Child safeguarding statement Cara safety statement Ensuring all external doors are closed after use. Ensuring all materials are stored away correctly
-----------------------------------	---	--

Important Note: It should be noted that risk in the context of this risk assessment is the risk of “harm” as defined in the Children First Act 2015 and not general health and safety risk. The definition of harm is set out in Chapter 4 of the *Child Protection Procedures for Primary and Post-Primary*

Schools 2017

In undertaking this risk assessment, the board of management has endeavoured to identify as far as possible the risks of harm that are relevant to this school and to ensure that adequate procedures are in place to manage all risks identified. While it is not possible to foresee and remove all risk of harm, the school has in place the procedures listed in this risk assessment to manage and reduce risk to the greatest possible extent.

This risk assessment has been completed by the General School Community and the Board of Management on *[insert date]*. It will be reviewed as part of the school’s annual review of its Child Safeguarding Statement.

Signed

Jannah Fin

Date

17.09.2026

A. Fin
Chairperson, Board of Management

Signed

Charlie

Date

17.09.2026

Principal/Secretary to the Board of Management